## ANNEX F

POA reaches and engages participants representing geographic, ethnic, racial, socio-economic, sexual orientation, and religious diversity. POA's commitment to Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) is reflected in our priority to grow and diversify our programs and the types of participants to ensure the inclusion of all cultures, experiences, and identities from regions around the globe. POA intentionally considers and acts upon ways in which to make its programs equitable and accessible.

The following table illustrates POA's DEI plan and best practices for the Education and Culture Program. Specifically, it lists how DEI procedures will be implemented in all phases of programming from administration and design to program content and implementation. The table also demonstrates how the Education and Culture Program will empower participants to incorporate DEI in their own lives. POA will work with ECA to implement these procedures and adjust as needed and on a case-by-case basis.

| Program Phase: Administration |
|---|
| **Procedures** |
| **Communications & Promotion**<br><br>• Messages and promotional materials will appropriately depict diverse and inclusive imagery of participants and communities.<br>• Consult guidelines and other resources established by DEI marketing specialists to ensure the use of inclusive language that reflects a broad range of identities and perspectives that does not stereotype or demean people based on implicit bias and perceptions of personal characteristics or cultural background.<br>• In sharing program impact through stories, POA will work closely with participants to make sure that their voices and ideas are accurately and appropriately presented in the text and images used.<br><br>**ADA-Compliant Accommodations and Event Spaces**<br><br>Accessible accommodation will be available for participants who require it. These may include mobility accessibility, closed captioning, sign language interpretation, and 508 compliance requirements, among other needs to accounts for the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) accessibility.<br><br>• POA will solicit hotel venues that cater to accessibility needs; for instance, elevator access, restrooms that are ADA-Compliant, accessible entrances (without stairs/steps), ramps, wheelchair/low vision/low hearing seating, clear and legible signs, etc.<br>• For the peer learning event, POA will ensure that the venue has all-gendered restrooms or that restrooms are open to designating specific restrooms as gender neutral.<br>• Ensure that the venue has the option to set up designated rooms as needed and when applicable – prayer room, mediation/quiet room, etc. |

**Inclusive Catering**

POA is aware that participants of the peer learning event may have varying eating customs due to religious or other dietary restrictions or cultural differences. As such, as part of registration for in-person events, POA will ask participants of any dietary considerations. This includes working with the hotel or catering companies to offer a diverse selection of food, such as kosher, halal, vegetarian, vegan, dairy-free, and gluten-free options as needed, and to clearly label any buffet-style meals. POA will also strive to avoid religious and cultural days for major program events and activities by including these days on our programmatic calendars.

**Reliable & Confidential Contacts**

As part of the program's Education and Culture welcome and orientation, POA will include a list of internal and external points of contact that will be accessible to participants at any point of the program and for various needs.

- Program-related issues: Education and Culture staff
- Emergency situations: *(POA staff)* Contacts will include POA local network in addition to the local police and fire departments
- DEI-related resources: ADA regional centers, LGBTQ+ support groups, etc.

**Continued Staff and Chapter Education**

- POA staff and Chapters will seek out continued training in and consultation about Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion best practices. This includes professional development, engaging in critical conversations, and staying up to date with guidelines and organizations such as: state & federal guidelines; American Association for Access, Equity, and Diversity; Americans with Disabilities Act Standards; LGBTQ Meeting Professionals Association; Marketing Partners; oneTILT, etc.

## Program Phase: Design

### Procedures

**Geographic Diversity**

POA, with ECA, will select the proposed program participants from locations that reflect geographic and socio-economic diversity of the Education and Culture Program.

**Program Materials**

- Program documents, such as registration forms, will ask questions on demographic data optional to participants. This includes gender, ethnicity, race, and other questions approved by ECA.
- Closely review and verify all resources shared with program participants, so that they contain a broad representation of subjects, authors, and titles reflecting diversity in the U.S. and abroad.

**Monitoring & Evaluation**

POA will make clear and visible that any demographic information collected will solely be used for the purpose of program analysis and to support efforts to reach underrepresented groups for the program, and that the data will only be shared in aggregated form for evaluation purposes.

Through virtual engagements, surveys, and reports, POA will seek feedback from participants on diversity, inclusion, and accessibility as it relates to their experience and programming. This includes whether:

- Peer learning event sessions incorporated instructors, speakers, and guests represented diverse fields and occupations;
- Differing perspectives were presented, shared, and encouraged;
- POA network projects addressed and explored DEI-related topics;
- Education and Culture Program expanded participant's capacity to think about diversity, equity, and inclusion-related topics;
- Participants felt prepared to incorporate DEI in their community projects and/or personal and professional paths;
- Exchange and subaward project development allowed participants to have contact with individuals of diverse backgrounds;
- Travel experience exposed participants to the fullest range of expressions, viewpoints, positions, and information; and
- Their personal/professional needs were met and further developed during the program.

**Addressing Communications Barriers**

Activities that require communication to participate will be cognizant and/or enable participation by people with hearing, vision, or speech disabilities.

- **Hearing Disabilities:** For group discussions, workshops, or question-and-answer situations, all visitors must be able to understand the information presented and respond in as unrestricted manner as possible. Assistive listening devices and/or interpreters can be made available. For in-person events, POA can collaborate with regional ADA Centers for support.

- **Vision Disabilities:** People with vision disabilities may need to be physically close to visually presented information, instructions, or activities. Additional explanations may be necessary to convey essential themes and facts. When relevant, sample objects may be made available for participants to touch and feel.

- **Cognitive or Developmental Disabilities**: Instructions will be clear and concise. Presenters will be provided tips on integrating everybody into the activities as much as possible, including adding pauses, patience, using visuals, and minimizing distractions.

## Program Phase: Content Development and Implementation

### Procedures

**DEI support**

- Program orientation: provide sensitivity guidelines that prohibit discrimination and promote mutual understanding and respect for diverse viewpoints, cultural competencies, and expressions.

- Program activities will be designed and will take place to allow for maximum accessibility and flexibility in participants' ability to participate.

**Education and Culture Program Materials for Accessibility**

- POA will develop and offer educational materials to aid in equitable access of Education and Culture subawards programming and continued growth post-grant. This includes feedback on denied applications, informational webinars, skills-building workshops, and multimedia support, guiding alumni through the entire grant process.

**Deep Dive with participants into DEI Issues**

- Offer various spaces and opportunities (e.g., seminars, workshops, meetings, consultations, and other forms of interaction, such as the PartnersConnect platform) that will allow for a broad exchange of views among program participants.

- Expose participants to the fullest range of expressions, viewpoints, positions, and information through interaction with people from diverse backgrounds, activities, and materials.

    - Plan activities to include access to organizations and community members representing the geographic, ethnic, racial, socio-economic, and religious diversity of the U.S., including people with disabilities.

    - Distribute resource lists, research material, and websites that contain a broad representation of subjects, voices, and titles reflecting diversity in the U.S. and abroad.

- Address relevant issues of diversity and inclusion through discussions, opportunities for reflection, and workshops, such as the PartnersIDEA initiative, that allow participants to:

    - Enhance their skills built during their exchanges (empathy, communication, open mindedness, self-advocacy, awareness of self and others, diplomacy, etc.) to continue growing as active global citizens and changemakers in all ways big and small;

    - Discover the many ways that people from different cultures and backgrounds hold similar values and beliefs;

    - Recognize how individuals place self-imposed limits on the way they think;

    - Become more aware of their own cultural viewpoints and the stereotypes they may have inadvertently picked up through their home/school/work environment;

    - Examine attitudes toward and expectations of people with different backgrounds;

    - Empower participants to infuse DEI best practices to mobilize resources more effectively (i.e., partnerships, establishing teams, designing inclusive and equitable projects, building a DEI mindset) in their personal and professional development, as well as within Education and Culture Program implementation.

- Introduce or increase subawardee understanding of DEI, as well as how to include it in the foundation of one's project and assess its progress. This will be done through training workshops and resources shared.

**Small Project Assistance Subaward and Travel Grant Equity**

- Provide a streamlined platform, Zengine, for applicants to access all resources.
- Provide trainings to potential applicants and grantees on how to navigate the virtual application and reporting process in order to make it accessible to all digital skills levels.
- Redact personal and identifying information of applicants in the review process, when possible, to reduce opportunity for bias.
- Host an orientation for proposal reviewers to discuss implicit biases and how to recognize and avoid them while reviewing a proposal.

PARTNERS *of the* AMERICAS

Connect • Serve • Change Lives

# Demographic Survey

This survey will not be linked to your application – all answers will be anonymous. You can select multiple answers to reflect your identity or select "I prefer not to say." Please respond based on how you identify. If you have any questions or concerns that you'd like to share, please reach out to us at EdCulture@partners.net

**Are you a U.S. Citizen or International Citizen? ***

- ◯ U.S. Citizen
- ◯ International Citizen
- ◯ Prefer not to say

**Please check the option that best describes your gender: ***

- ◯ Female
- ◯ Male
- ◯ Non-binary
- ◯ Transgender
- ◯ Prefer not to say
- ◯ Prefer to self-describe

**How would you describe your sexual orientation?**

- ◯ Bisexual
- ◯ Heterosexual
- ◯ Lesbian/Gay
- ◯ Prefer not to say
- ◯ Prefer to self-describe

**Please check the option that best describes your racial and/or ethnic identity? (Choose all that apply) ***

- ☐ American Indian or Indigenous American
- ☐ Asian
- ☐ Black or African American
- ☐ Hispanic, Latino, or Latinx
- ☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander
- ☐ White

- [ ] Prefer not to say
- [ ] Prefer to self-describe below

**Would you consider yourself to have a disability? ***

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No
- ◯ Prefer not to say

**If you answered yes and you'd like to share more, please do so below:**

**What is your age? ***

- ◯ 18-24 years old
- ◯ 25-34 years old
- ◯ 35-44 years old
- ◯ 45-54 years old
- ◯ 55 years old or above
- ◯ Prefer not to say

**What is your current highest level of education? ***

- ◯ High School/Secondary Degree
- ◯ GED or Alternative Credential
- ◯ Some College
- ◯ Associates Degree
- ◯ Bachelor's Degree
- ◯ Master's Degree
- ◯ Professional Degree Beyond Bachelor’s Degree (for example: MD, DDS, DVM, LLB, JD)
- ◯ Doctorate Degree (for examples: PhD, EdD)
- ◯ Prefer not to say

**Have you received and managed a grant in the past? (This helps us know how to support you through your application or grant) ***

- ◯ No
- ◯ Yes, one or two
- ◯ Yes, many
- ◯ Prefer not to say

---

Submit